

Weak Two-bids

Open 2♦, 2♥ or 2♠ with a 6-card suit headed by some honors and fewer 4-9 HCP.

Response of a new suit is not forcing. (Note: some pairs play this 1-round force)

Raise of Opener's suit is to play.

Response of 2NT is forcing and asks for further information.

After 2NT Response, Opener bids:

- 3 of original suit to show a weak hand

- 3 of another suit to show a good hand with high card in that suit

- 3NT with a suit of A K Q x x x

Preemptive Bids

An opening bid of 3 of any suit shows a 7-card suit and less than opening hand.

This is primarily a defensive bid, and you should be mindful of vulnerability, being more cautious when you are Vulnerable against Non-Vulnerable opponents. For these Deals assume neither side is Vulnerable.

As a rule of thumb, Responder should assume Opener can win six tricks and bid accordingly.

Board: 1
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 6NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣6

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4♠
Declarer: East
Lead: ♦Q

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 3♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♦K

Board: 4
Dealer: **East**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣A

Board: 5
Dealer: **South**
Contract: 4♥
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠9

Board: 6
Dealer: **West**
Contract: 3NT
Declarer: East
Lead: ♥K

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 8 7 3 2

♥ J 5 4

♦ 8 2

♣ J 9

♠ K Q J

♥ A K 7

♦ J 6 3

♣ A K 4 2



♠ A 6

♥ Q 10 9 2

♦ 10 5

♣ Q 10 7 6 3

♠ 5 4

♥ 8 6 3

♦ A K Q 9 7 4

♣ 8 5

The 2NT response to a Weak Two opening is a wonderful tool. You can learn a lot about partner's hand and you are absolutely certain that it will not be passed out.

In this Deal NORTH has a huge hand and SOUTH opens 2♦. There are a lot of approaches NORTH might try, but the simplest is to start with 2NT.

When SOUTH shows ♦ A K Q x x x NORTH has an easy 6NT bid.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			2♦
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			
6NT by North			
Lead: ♣6			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K J 6
♥ A Q J 4 2
♦ 9 6 4
♣ A 5

♠ 8 3

♥ 9 7 6

♦ A K 10 7

♣ K Q 10 2



♠ A Q 9 7 5 2

♥ K 3

♦ 8 5 2

♣ 7 3

♠ 10 4

♥ 10 8 5

♦ Q J 3

♣ J 9 8 6 4

WEST is unsure whether to bid game or not. So she temporizes with 2NT.

EAST shows an above average hand plus a high card in ♥s.

WEST is no longer unsure, so she bids 4♠.

*West**North**East**South*

2♠

Pass

2NT

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by East

Lead: ♦Q

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 7
♥ K 10 9
♦ A K 10 5
♣ J 8 4 3

♠ K J 3

♥ A Q J 4 2

♦ 9 6 4

♣ A 5



♠ 5 2

♥ 8 7 6

♦ Q J 2

♣ K Q 10 9 6

♠ A Q 9 8 6 4

♥ 5 3

♦ 8 7 3

♣ 7 2

NORTH is unsure whether to bid game or not, so he bids 2NT to get more information about SOUTH's hand.

SOUTH's 3♠ is discouraging, a hand below average in strength and no outside high card.

NORTH passes and hopes for the best.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			2♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3♠
All Pass			
3♠ by South			
Lead: ♦K			

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 6 3

♥ A K Q J 7 4 2

♦ A 8

♣ 4

♠ K J 10 8 7 2

♥ 10 9

♦ K 10 4

♣ A 7



♠ 5

♥ 8

♦ 9 7 5 3

♣ K Q J 9 8 6 3

♠ Q 9 4

♥ 6 5 3

♦ Q J 6 2

♣ 10 5 2

WEST has no way to tell whether EAST can provide one winner or not.

So she takes the bold approach and bids 4♥.

If the opening lead is a ♠ or a ♦ then WEST will probably make the game. Otherwise she will likely go down one.

*West**North**East**South*

3♣

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by West

Lead: ♣A

Board 5

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 6 5
 ♥ 10 8
 ♦ J 9 8 4
 ♣ K J 10 3

♠ K 3

♥ A J 9 6 3

♦ A Q 7

♣ 8 6 4



♠ 9 8

♥ 5 4

♦ K 10 6 3

♣ A Q 7 5 2

♠ Q J 10 7 4 2

♥ K Q 7 2

♦ 5 2

♣ 9

Most good players have an extra restriction in their Weak Two-bid guidelines - they won't open with a Weak Two-bid when they hold an outside 4-card Major, even if the hand qualifies otherwise. This Deal shows why.

If SOUTH opened with 2♠, NORTH might well pass and a ♥ game would be missed.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			Pass
Pass	1♥	Pass	3♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			
4♥ by North			
Lead: ♠9			

Board 6

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 6 2
♥ 7 4 2
♦ A J 10 8 3 2
♣ K 7

♠ 10 8 7 5 4

♥ 9 8 3

♦ Q

♣ 9 8 5 3

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♠ A Q 3

♥ A J 10

♦ K 7 5 4

♣ Q 10 4

♠ K J 9

♥ K Q 6 5

♦ 9 6

♣ A J 6 2

EAST responds 2NT, asking for more information.

When WEST shows a decent hand with a high ♣
EAST should bid 3NT.

West	North	East	South
2 ♦	Pass	2NT	Pass
3 ♣	Pass	3NT	
All Pass			
3NT by East			
Lead: ♥K			